NM

NORMAN K. MUHWEZI

DIGITAL TRANSFORMATION & INNOVATION LEADER
PRINCE2® PRACTITIONER

✓ CORNELL-CERTIFIED · AI SOLUTIONS, 2025

CONTACT

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LANGUAGES

English · Fluent
French · Professional Working Proficiency

CORE COMPETENCIES

- Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI) & Platform Delivery
- Public-Private Partnerships & Resource Mobilisation
- Digital Transformation Strategy & Delivery
- Programme Effectiveness & Impact Measurement
- AI Adoption Strategy & Responsible Deployment
- Vendor Evaluation & Procurement (RFP)
- Multi-Country / Cross-Organisation Coordination

PROFILE

Fifteen years turning digital strategy into delivery

Digital transformation and innovation leader with 15+ years' experience launching and scaling technology programmes across Africa. I have directed a $20M+ portfolio, scaled digital platforms to 12.6M+ users, including civil registration and payment-linked services, and co-developed and led delivery of a $12.6M public-private partnership, building the government and private-sector partnerships that keep systems running after launch. I now apply that delivery discipline to AI adoption, backed by a Cornell certificate in AI solution design. A telecom engineering foundation, with 2,000+ network sites delivered across Uganda and Sudan, keeps my approach grounded in operational rigour.

FLAGSHIP DELIVERY · PLASTIC BRICKS PPP

Co-developed and led delivery of a $12.6M public-private partnership *with Conceptos Plasticos, converting 2,600+ tons of recycled plastic into 300+ classrooms for 15,000+ children in Côte d'Ivoire. Led the 2018 pilot, the first of its kind in UNICEF, and showcased a model classroom at the 2019 UN General Assembly. Women waste collectors supplied the plastic and young people built them. Set up real-time construction monitoring and independent quality and toxicity testing, and won $212,000 in government cost reimbursement.*

EXPERIENCE

2026 – present

Unified Technology Business Partners

Advisor, Growth & Digital Transformation · Kampala

- **Advise a Kampala-based IT, digital transformation, and AI firm** on AI adoption and digital transformation across banking, government, healthcare, and fintech.
- **Built a tender qualification workflow in Claude** that scores each opportunity, runs a gap analysis, and recommends bid or pass, cutting the time to a bid decision from about a week to a day.

Apr 2025 – Jan 2026

Professional Development: AI & Digital Transformation

Career Transition & AI Upskilling · Addis Ababa

- **Completed Cornell University's Designing and Building AI Solutions certificate** (2025) and an AI Agent Bootcamp with Distinction (2026). Duke AI Product Management (Coursera) is in progress.

2023 – 2025

UNICEF Democratic Republic of Congo

Innovation Manager & Acting SBC Section Chief · Kinshasa

Acting Section Chief for a cumulative 6.5 months, directing a $20M+ portfolio and 20 staff.

- **Built and led the Web Fact Checkers misinformation-detection programme**, adopting third-party AI tools (Talkwalker social listening and Google image analysis), and trained 700 youth volunteers, who documented 100,000+ counter-misinformation actions and reached 3.4M+ people.
- **Scaled U-Report DRC** (UNICEF's SMS-based youth engagement platform) to 8.6M+ users, ranked #1 globally, across 300+ community clubs in every province, including 120+ girls-only clubs, and connected it to UNICEF's cash-transfer verification system (HOPE). Drafted the winning UNICEF Inspire Award submission (2023).
- **Led vendor selection and procurement** (Nyaruka/RapidPro, GoInnovation) for the DRC digital platform portfolio, then directed delivery of FunDoo, a youth livelihoods platform, through five-language localisation, user-testing, and a 10,000-user beta launch.
- **Managed and grew partnerships with four mobile network operators** (Orange, Vodacom, Airtel, and Africell), sustaining 219M+ free SMS in 2024 and securing supplementary data packages from Orange for top-performing communities.
- **Chaired the DRC Accountability to Affected Populations (AAP) Committee** and secured $850,000 for community feedback systems.

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EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Designing & Building AI Solutions 2025
Cornell University, USA

AI Agent Bootcamp, Distinction 2026
Lonely Octopus

Master of Business Administration (MBA)
East & Southern Africa Management Institute, Tanzania (2015)

PRINCE2® Practitioner Certificate
APMG International, UK (2011)

BSc (Hons) Telecommunication Engineering
Makerere University, Uganda (2009)

PLATFORMS & TOOLS

- n8n (AI Agent Workflows)
- RapidPro
- Power BI
- Talkwalker (Social Listening)
- U-Report
- Real-time Dashboards
- Sprint Planning & UAT

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2022 — UNICEF Sierra Leone

Innovation Manager (Short-Term Mission) · Freetown · Jul–Oct 2022

Led a team of 2 national staff and 2 international consultants.

- **Negotiated Project Giga's vendor contracts** for a 6% cost reduction and helped secure $500K to expand school internet connectivity across Sierra Leone.
- Led deployment of the Learning Passport digital-learning platform, training 87 Ministry of Education staff, and oversaw GenU eUPSHIFT youth enterprise work.
- Restructured the Innovation Unit's project deployment process, improving fund-utilisation from 35% to 84%.

2016 – 2023 — UNICEF Côte d'Ivoire

Innovation Specialist · Abidjan · Dec 2016–Mar 2023

- **Established and scaled U-Report Côte d'Ivoire** to 4 million users, ranked #2 globally, negotiating zero-rated SMS agreements with three operators (MTN, Orange, and Moov).
- **Led digitisation of mobile-money payments for 30,000+ frontline workers**, from requirements and MNO integration through to operations, leading to long-term payment agreements with three operators.
- **Authored and launched the roadmap for YOMA** (a skills-to-opportunity platform), integrating it with U-Report and co-securing $2.08M to scale it regionally with UNICEF Nigeria and WCARO.
- **Led UNICEF's RapidPro component of digital civil registration** with the Ministry of Justice and ONA: co-designed workflows, managed implementation and UAT, built a RapidPro-to-Power BI pipeline, and trained 50+ registration agents for the government pilot.
- **Launched and ran the national CORONA chatbot** with the Ministry of Health, consulted 3M+ times and adopted for national radio and TV campaigns. Designed the 2021 Ebola chatbot, now a UNICEF global template across 5+ country offices.
- **UNICEF focal point for U-Test HIV self-testing** ($2M, Côte d'Ivoire, Nigeria, and Cameroon), which grew from a $1M Grand Challenges grant I co-wrote. Co-drafted the $500K national LMS proposal.

2009 – 2016 — MTN Uganda

Project Manager & Senior Engineer, Radio Planning · Kampala · Sep 2009–Apr 2016

Started as a Radio Planning & Network Service Delivery Engineer before advancing to Project Manager & Senior Engineer.

- **Directed end-to-end RAN modernisation** across 1,000+ sites (700+ GSM, 300+ WCDMA, 80+ LTE), coordinating Huawei and tower companies ATC and Eaton.
- Negotiated vendor and subcontractor contracts for $75,000+ in annual CAPEX savings, and contributed to MTN Uganda's #1 national Quality-of-Service ranking (UCC, 2014).

2016 — MTN Sudan

Wireless Project Manager · Khartoum · May–Nov 2016

- **Oversaw a RAN swap** across 830+ 2G/3G sites (Ericsson/ZTE to Huawei) and commissioned 450+ LTE sites, bringing sites managed to 1,000+.
- Led the transmission network's migration from TDM to IP RAN, managing Huawei's delivery and risk controls to protect network availability.

15+
Years across telecom infrastructure & digital transformation delivery

$20M+
Portfolio directed as Acting Section Chief, UNICEF DRC

2,000+
Telecom sites delivered or modernised across Uganda and Sudan

12.6M+
Combined U-Report users: DRC (8.6M+, #1 globally) & Côte d'Ivoire (4M, #2 globally)

$12.6M
Recycled-plastic classrooms PPP: 2,600+ tons, 300+ classrooms